

LAW FIRM OFFICE PORTAL

MLF Complete Site User Guide

One complete document: how to access the portal and how every module works, step by step.

For office staff, advocates, accountants, and administrators

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1. What this portal is

MLF is the law firm's internal office portal. It is used to manage clients, cases, hearings, appointments, cash payments, postal dak, work allotment, HR attendance/leave, reports, and staff permissions — in one place.

Typical users: Admin, Sub-admin (office/HR manager), Staff (clerks, PA, receptionist), Advocates, and Accountants.

- You open the site in a web browser (desktop recommended).
- You sign in with your Indian mobile number and a 6-digit PIN.
- What you see in the left menu depends on your role and permissions.
- All important actions are logged in Activity for accountability.

Note: This guide is for using the live site. It is not a developer/setup manual.

2. How to access the site

2.1 Open the portal

Step 1: Open the portal URL provided by your office (for example the production website address).

Step 2: If you are not logged in, you are taken to the Login page.

Step 3: After a successful login you land on Home (/).

2.2 First-time setup (new user / no PIN yet)

Step 1: Enter your 10-digit Indian mobile number (must start with 6–9).

Step 2: Continue. The system detects that you need PIN setup.

Step 3: Request OTP. An SMS OTP is sent to your mobile (via 2Factor).

Step 4: Enter the OTP and verify.

Step 5: Create a 6-digit PIN (and confirm it). Avoid weak PINs such as 000000, 123456, or repeated digits.

Step 6: You are signed in and redirected to Home.

2.3 Returning user (normal daily login)

Step 1: Enter your 10-digit mobile number.

Step 2: Enter your 6-digit PIN.

Step 3: Submit. A secure session cookie is set and you go to Home.

2.4 Forgot PIN

Step 1: On the PIN screen, choose Forgot PIN.

Step 2: Request OTP !' enter OTP from SMS !' verify.

Step 3: Set a new 6-digit PIN (confirm it).

Step 4: You are signed in with the new PIN.

2.5 PIN logout

Too many wrong PIN attempts locks the PIN temporarily. Wait for the countdown, or use Forgot PIN to reset via OTP.

2.6 Logout

Step 1: Open the user menu (profile area in the header).

Step 2: Choose Logout. Session cookies are cleared and you return to Login.

2.7 Session expired

If your session expires while working, the app clears cookies and sends you back to Login. Sign in again with mobile + PIN.

3. Roles & what each person can do

Access is role-based. Admin has full control. Other roles get a default set of permissions (which Admin can adjust on the Permissions page).

Role	Meant for	Typical access
Admin	Firm owner / full control	Everything; cannot be restricted
Sub admin	Office / HR manager	Ops: clients, cases, HRMS approve, employees, reports
Staff	Clerks, PA, reception	Clients, cases, appointments, dak, tasks
Advocate	Counsel / advocates	Clients, cases, appointments, dak, tasks
Accountant	Accounts team	Accounts cash book, view clients/cases, reports

Everyone gets

- Home (dashboard) view
- HRMS view + own attendance check-in/out + own leave requests
- Notifications inbox (bell) and Profile

Permission actions you may see

- View — open list/detail screens
- Create — add new records
- Edit — change existing records
- Upload / import — CSV bulk import (and related uploads)
- Deactivate — deactivate employees
- Cancel — cancel appointments
- Own attendance / Own leave / Team attendance / Approve leave — HRMS splits

Note: If a menu item is missing, you do not have permission (or the module is disabled). Ask Admin.

4. Screen layout & navigation

4.1 Main areas

- Left sidebar — modules grouped as Workspace, Matters, Schedule, Office, Admin.
- Header — global search (# K / Ctrl+K), notification bell, user menu.
- Main content — list, filters, forms, detail panels for the selected module.

4.2 Menu map

Group	Menu label	Opens
Workspace	Home	Dashboard summary
Matters	Clients	Client registry
Matters	Cases	Case pipeline & hearings
Matters	Day board	Day view: hearings + appointments + tasks
Schedule	Appointments	Consultations / bookings
Schedule	Availability	Advocate hours & blocks
Office	Accounts	Cash payments / fees
Office	HRMS	Attendance, leave, holidays
Office	Postal	In/out dak register
Office	Work allotment	Office tasks
Office	Reports	Excel exports

Admin	Employees	Staff & advocate users
Admin	Activity	Audit log
Admin	Permissions	Role permission matrix

Also reachable (not always in main nav)

- Notifications — header bell !' full inbox
- Profile — user menu !' your photo / details
- Documents — inside Case / Client screens (no separate Documents menu)

5. Home dashboard & global search

5.1 Home

Step 1: After login, open Home (or click Home in the sidebar).

Step 2: Review summary cards / today's focus (hearings, appointments, tasks as permitted).

Step 3: Use shortcuts from the dashboard into Cases, Day board, or other modules.

5.2 Global search

Step 1: Press # K (Mac) or Ctrl+K (Windows), or open the search control in the header.

Step 2: Type a client name, case id, mobile fragment, etc.

Step 3: Select a result to jump to that record.

6. Clients

Clients is the party registry. Most cases and payments link to a client record (IDs like CLI-00001).

6.1 View clients

Step 1: Open Clients from Matters.

Step 2: Use search / pagination to find a client.

Step 3: Open a row to see detail.

6.2 Create a client

Step 1: Click Create / Add (needs clients.create).

Step 2: Enter name, mobile (10 digits), and other intake fields (including SMS consent if shown).

Step 3: Save. A client unit ID is generated automatically.

6.3 Edit a client

Step 1: Open the client.

Step 2: Edit fields and save (needs clients.edit).

6.4 Import clients (CSV)

See Section 15. Recommended first import when migrating data.

7. Cases, hearings & documents

Cases track matters from enquiry through disposal. Each case links to a client and may have advocates, hearings, documents, and fee payments.

7.1 Case pipeline statuses

Status	Meaning
Enquiry	Consultation / early enquiry
Engaged	Client engaged the firm
Pre-filing	Draft / preparation before filing
Under filing	Being filed
Filing defect	Returned with defect
Active	Numbered / active matter
Reserved	Judgment reserved
Disposed	Disposed
Withdrawn	Withdrawn
Transferred	Transferred
Archived	Archived

Status changes follow allowed transitions only (the system blocks invalid jumps).

7.2 Create a case

Step 1: Open Cases !' Create (needs cases.create).

Step 2: Select the client (must exist first).

Step 3: Fill opposing party, court, stage/status, advocates (optional), and other matter fields.

Step 4: Save. A case unit ID is generated (e.g. CAS-00001).

7.3 Open case detail

Step 1: From the Cases list, open a case.

Step 2: Review client link, status pipeline, hearings list, documents, and fee snippet.

Step 3: Update status when the matter moves (needs cases.edit).

Step 4: Complete filing checklist items if shown.

7.4 Hearings

Step 1: On case detail, add a hearing (date/time, court notes as required).

Step 2: Saving updates the case next hearing date; notifications may be sent.

Step 3: To adjourn: use adjourn on the hearing — this creates a replacement hearing.

Step 4: Bulk hearings can be imported via CSV (see Section 15).

7.5 Documents on a case / client

Step 1: Open the Documents panel on the case (or client) screen.

Step 2: Upload a file (allowed types/sizes enforced by the system).

Step 3: Download later from the same panel (permission follows cases / accounts rules by document type).

Note: There is no standalone Documents page in the main menu — documents live on the related case/client.

7.6 Hearing SMS (automatic reminder)

A scheduled job can SMS clients about tomorrow's hearings. Manual triggers may also exist from Day board / diary tools for authorized users.

8. Day board (diary)

Day board shows one IST calendar day: hearings + appointments + tasks together. You can open it if you have view access to Cases, Appointments, or Tasks.

Step 1: Open Day board from Matters.

Step 2: Pick the date (defaults to today).

Step 3: Review each section: court hearings, appointments, allotted work.

Step 4: Click an item to open its full record.

Step 5: Use notify / hearing SMS actions if available and permitted.

9. Appointments & advocate availability

9.1 Appointments

Step 1: Open Appointments under Schedule.

Step 2: Create an appointment: client/contact, advocate, date-time, purpose.

Step 3: Edit or cancel as needed (cancel needs appointments.cancel).

Step 4: Convert to enquiry case when the consultation becomes a matter (Convert action on the appointment).

9.2 Availability

Step 1: Open Availability under Schedule.

Step 2: Set advocate weekly hours.

Step 3: Add time blocks (leave, court, unavailable windows).

Step 4: Booking screens use these rules so slots respect hours and blocks.

10. Accounts (cash / payments)

Accounts is the cash ledger for client/case fees and related payments. Accountants typically work here daily.

Step 1: Open Accounts under Office.

Step 2: Filter by client, case, date, or purpose as needed.

Step 3: Record a payment: link client (and case if known), amount, purpose, mode/notes.

Step 4: Save. A payment unit ID is created.

Step 5: To reverse a wrong entry, use Void (do not delete casually — void keeps the audit trail).

Step 6: On a case detail screen, fee rollup may show payments filtered for that case.

CSV import of payments is available (sample file is named payments.sample.csv). Needs accounts.upload.

11. HRMS (attendance & leave)

11.1 Own attendance

Step 1: Open HRMS.

Step 2: Check in at the start of work; check out at the end (own_attendance).

Step 3: Review your attendance history on the same screen.

11.2 Own leave

Step 1: In HRMS, open Leave.

Step 2: Submit a leave request with dates and reason (own_leave).

Step 3: Wait for approval from a manager who has approve_leave.

11.3 Managers

Step 1: Approve or reject pending leave (approve_leave).

Step 2: Manage team attendance / corrections if you have manage_attendance.

Step 3: Maintain office holidays under Holidays (as permitted).

12. Postal register (DAK)

Postal / DAK tracks inward and outward office dak (letters, parcels, courier).

Step 1: Open Postal under Office.

Step 2: Create an entry: in/out, reference, parties, date, remarks.

Step 3: Edit when status or details change.

Step 4: Import historical dak via CSV if migrating (Section 15).

13. Work allotment (tasks)

Office tasks assign work to staff/advocates, often linked to a case.

Step 1: Open Work allotment under Office.

Step 2: Create a task: title, assignee, due date, linked case (optional).

Step 3: Update status as work progresses (assignees may get notifications).

Step 4: Due items also appear on Day board for the selected day.

14. Reports & Excel exports

Step 1: Open Reports (needs reports.view).

Step 2: Choose an export type (examples: cases, clients, employees, tasks, dak, accounts, appointments, fees outstanding, and other types listed in the UI).

Step 3: Download the Excel file.

Note: Each export also requires view permission on that domain (e.g. cases export needs cases.view as well as reports.view).

15. CSV bulk import

Most list screens offer Import. Always dry-run first, then confirm. Sample CSVs download from the Import dialog.

15.1 Safe import procedure (every time)

Step 1: Open the module !' Import.

Step 2: Download the sample CSV for that module.

Step 3: Fill rows in Excel/Sheets; save as UTF-8 CSV with the header row.

Step 4: Upload !' Dry run. Fix any row errors shown.

Step 5: Confirm import (writes data + audit).

15.2 Recommended import order

Order	Module	Why
1	Clients	Creates CLI-... IDs used later
2	Cases	Needs clientUnitId from step 1
3+	Hearings / Payments / Dak / Tasks / Appointments	Link with caseUnitId / clientUnitId
Any	Employees	Independent user roster (admin)

15.3 CSV rules

- UTF-8 CSV; header row required.
- Dates: YYYY-MM-DD (IST). Appointment scheduledAt may be full ISO datetime.
- Mobile: 10 digits (system normalizes to 91...).
- Link related rows with *UnitId columns only.
- Empty unitId on clients/cases/employees !' auto-generated.
- Unknown extra columns are ignored (shown in dry-run as ignored).

15.4 Permissions for import

Import	Permission needed
Clients	clients.create (+ edit for upsert)
Cases	cases.upload (+ edit for upsert)
Hearings	cases.edit
Accounts / payments	accounts.upload
Employees	employees.create (+ edit for upsert)
DAK	dak.create

Tasks	tasks.create
Appointments	appointments.create

16. Employees & user accounts

Step 1: Admin/Sub-admin opens Employees.

Step 2: Create employee: name, mobile, role(s), designation as required.

Step 3: The person signs in with that mobile and sets/uses a PIN (OTP flow on first login).

Step 4: Edit profile details; upload photo if supported.

Step 5: Deactivate when someone leaves (deactivate permission). Reactivate if they return.

Step 6: Force reset PIN when a user is locked out and cannot use OTP themselves (admin tools).

Note: Only Admin can assign the Admin role. Sub-admin can manage other employees within policy.

17. Permissions administration

Step 1: Admin opens Permissions (permissions.view / edit).

Step 2: Review the matrix: each role × each module.action.

Step 3: Turn allowed on/off for Sub-admin, Staff, Advocate, Accountant as your office policy requires.

Step 4: Save. Users get the union of permissions from all their roles on next session use.

Admin remains full access by design.

18. Notifications & profile

18.1 Notifications

Step 1: Click the bell in the header to see recent alerts.

Step 2: Open the full Notifications page from there if needed.

Step 3: Mark items read as you handle them.

Alerts are created by office events (e.g. task assigned, hearing updates). Live push may be enabled on some deployments; otherwise the UI polls.

18.2 Profile

Step 1: Open user menu !' Profile.

Step 2: Update display details / photo as allowed.

Step 3: Logout from the same menu when finished for the day.

19. Activity (audit log)

Step 1: Open Activity under Admin (activity.view).

Step 2: Filter/search recent creates, updates, voids, imports, and other audited actions.

Step 3: Use this for accountability and troubleshooting "who changed what".

20. End-to-end office workflows

20.1 New client !' case !' hearing !' fee

Step 1: Create Client (or find existing).

Step 2: Create Case linked to that client; set status (often Enquiry or Engaged).

Step 3: Assign advocates; move status through pre-filing / filing / active as work progresses.

Step 4: Add Hearings; watch Day board for the hearing day.

Step 5: Upload Documents on the case.

Step 6: Record fee Payments in Accounts against client/case.

Step 7: When finished, move status to Disposed / Withdrawn / Archived as appropriate.

20.2 Consultation !' appointment !' case

Step 1: Set advocate Availability.

Step 2: Book Appointment.

Step 3: After meeting, Convert appointment to enquiry Case if engaged.

Step 4: Continue on the Cases workflow above.

20.3 Daily office rhythm

Step 1: Login !' check Home + Notifications.

Step 2: Open Day board for today — hearings, appointments, tasks.

Step 3: HRMS check-in.

Step 4: Work Cases / Clients / Accounts / Dak / Tasks as assigned.

Step 5: Export Reports if needed for accounts or management.

Step 6: HRMS check-out !' Logout.

20.4 Onboarding a new staff member

Step 1: Admin creates Employee with correct role.

Step 2: Adjust Permissions if the default role matrix is not enough.

Step 3: Staff opens site !' OTP !' set PIN !' starts work.

21. Quick reference checklist

Access

- URL !' Login !' Mobile !' PIN (or OTP setup / forgot PIN) !' Home
- Logout from user menu; session expiry returns to Login

Where to do common jobs

I need to...	Go to
Register a party	Clients
Open / move a matter	Cases
See today's court & meetings	Day board
Book a consultation	Appointments
Set advocate free slots	Availability
Record a fee / cash entry	Accounts
Check in / apply leave	HRMS
Log inward/outward post	Postal
Assign office work	Work allotment
Download Excel	Reports
Bulk upload CSV	Module !' Import (dry-run first)
Add a staff login	Employees
Change who can do what	Permissions
See who changed data	Activity
Upload case papers	Case detail !' Documents

IDs you will see

- CLI-... clients
- CAS-... cases (and similar unit IDs for hearings, payments, tasks, etc.)
- Public IDs are these unit IDs — use them in imports and when speaking with support.

End of guide

If a button or menu is missing, ask your Admin to grant the matching permission or confirm the module is enabled.

